

As I went down to the river to pray

Text: African American Spiritual

Music: African American Spiritual

AS I WENT DOWN TO THE RIVER TO PRAY irregular

The musical score is written for a single melodic line on a treble clef staff. The key signature has two flats (Bb and Eb), and the time signature is 2/2. The melody is composed of eighth and quarter notes, with some measures containing triplets. Above the staff, there are guitar chord diagrams for various chords: Eb (2 3 1), Bb (3 2 1 1), Eb (2 3 1), Bb (3 2 1 1), Ab (4 1 3 2), Eb (2 3 1), Bb (3 2 1 1), Eb (2 3 1), Ab (4 1 3 2), and Eb (2 3 1). The lyrics are written below the staff, with some words hyphenated. The score ends with a double bar line and the word 'Fine'.

As I went down to the riv-er to pray, stud-y-in' a-bout that good old way,
and who shall wear the star - ry crown, good Lord, show me the way.
1 Oh, sis - ters, let's go down, let's go down, come on down.
Oh, sis - ters, let's go down, down to the riv-er to pray.

2. Oh, brothers, ...

3. Oh, children, ...

4. Oh, sinners, ...